The Rite of Opening the Eyes

Pratiṣṭhāvidhi · Toh 1284 · Derge Tengyur

སྐུ་དབྱེ་ཆོ་ག

The Rite of Opening the Eyes, in Tibetan Chen Yewé Choga and in Sanskrit Pratiṣṭhāvidhi, the rite of consecration, is a short tantric ritual manual catalogued as Toh 1284 in the Tengyur, among the commentaries on the tantras. Opening with homage to the yoginīs, it explains how a vajra master consecrates sacred supports such as images, stūpas and books, noting that consecration is ultimately unnecessary for one who sees that nothing is born, yet is performed so that beginners' mindstreams may ripen. It sets out an extensive form of the rite, with the approach recitation, the maṇḍala, the bathing of the deities, offerings, the opening of the eyes with a golden probe, the invitation of the wisdom beings and a request for forbearance, and a concise one-day form for a capable master. The rite belongs to the Hevajra tradition and is written in a mixture of prose, verse and mantra.

In the language of India: pratistabidhiḥ. In the language of Tibet: The Rite of Opening the Eyes.

Homage to the yoginīs.

So that the vajra master may perform the act of consecration, I shall explain the characteristics of the rite by which consecration is done and of that into which it is done. Yet this is not fitting or necessary for everyone: in what is unborn, what is there to consecrate?

Even for one who practises chiefly at the conventional level,
if he knows that this very thing is blessing,
the rite of consecration is not fitting.
It is done for beginner sentient beings
so that their mindstreams may fully ripen.

Moreover, according to whether the master has attained power or not, the rite is either concise or extensive; this should be understood, as appropriate, by those who rely on the guru's instructions.

Of these, the extensive rite is as follows. First one performs the approach: a hundred thousand recitations for the principal deity, or ten thousand for the retinue, that number, or else the approach until the signs appear. One properly performs the rites for drawing the maṇḍala, builds the platform for

the bathing place, and arranges the vases. The rite of recitation is done through the yoga of one's own chosen deity.

From the vase that has the proper characteristics,
a little of all the waters is poured into a bowl,
and the victorious vase
is placed upon a jewel arisen from paṃ.
There one should generate the maṇḍala,
complete as the commitment beings,
and having invited the wisdom maṇḍala,
one offers water for the mouth and the rest in order.
Having made them enter together with the commitment beings,
one satisfies them with offerings,
and with flowers, incense and the rest, and with music,
one should worship them with diligence.
Ringing the bells,
with praises one bathes all the sugatas:
with the pure water of the gods
I shall likewise wash them.

oṃ sarvatathāgatakāyasabhiśekasamayaśriye hūṃ. This is the bathing mantra.

Cloth and the rest are to be offered
in meditative equipoise, each with its own secret mantra,
or else they are offered with one's own mantra.
Reciting it, one bows to the principal deity.

oṃ vajravāsase svāhā. This also becomes the mantra for flowers and the rest.

Having made a vessel of gold or the like,
with a golden probe
smeared with honey, butter and cream,
one opens the eyes, or else does so by meditation.

oṃ cakṣu samanta cakṣu viśodhani svāhā.

Just as all the perfect buddhas
abode perfectly in Tuṣita,
and just as in the womb of the goddess Māyā,
so likewise, abide in this place.
Having entered here continually,

O Protector, these flowers and the rest,
because they are gathered by the mind of awakening,
accept them for the sake of so and so.
Wishing the deities to remain stable,
at the head, the heart and the secret place
one circles with the vajra;
circling three times, one consecrates.

Whatever I have done in reciting,
whether deficient or in excess,
since you are the refuge of embodied beings,
O Protector, please forgive it.
What was not obtained and what was not known,
please forgive it all without remainder.
Whatever was done deficiently or otherwise,
it is fitting that you forgive it.

With this one asks forgiveness and makes aspirations.

Stūpas, books and the like
are to be consecrated through Hevajra with his retinue,
in their aspects, as is fitting.

Then one brings the disciple into the root maṇḍala and instructs him, saying, "Make offerings as you please."

Then one performs the activities of torma and fire offering; the rites for these are to be learned elsewhere. Preceded by offerings and praises, one requests the wisdom deities to depart, and so forth. That is the extensive rite.

A capable vajra master may complete the consecration rite in a single day. Having performed the stage of generating oneself as one's own deity, one recites the mantra of one's own deity a hundred or a thousand times. One purifies the support to be consecrated and makes the wisdom being that rests in it enter; then with mental offerings one performs the offerings and recitation as appropriate.

It is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The Sanskrit title is given as the Tibetan spells it; the Tibetan title is literally "The Rite of Opening the Eyes," while the body of the text concerns consecration (pratiṣṭhā) generally. In the verse on Māyā, □□□□□□ is read as an evident slip for □□□□□, "womb," so the sense is "just as in the womb of the goddess Māyā," i.e., as the Buddha entered his mother's womb. "So and so" renders □□□□□□□□, the placeholder for the patron's name.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.